Marking Fewer Sentences: A Reading-Coach Sample

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Abstract

This sample page imitates the first page of an empirical paper. Its central claim is that a reading coach should mark only the few sentences that carry the argument, and explain why each one matters. The method builds an annotation plan before any highlight is written to the file. The main result is a short list of anchor sentences per page, each with a note about its role in the paper. A limitation is that exact phrase search can fail on ligatures, formulas and scanned pages.

1 Introduction

Readers who highlight every sentence lose the signal that highlighting is meant to give. We define an anchor as a highlighted passage that a reader should return to when reviewing the paper. Density is measured by anchors per body page, not by the total number of annotation objects. In this sample we therefore compare the number of anchors with the number of body pages and body words.

2 Method

Each run starts from a reading goal such as quick-read or literature-review. The plan lists the target sentence, the colour, a short note and the reason for including it. Only after the plan exists does the tool search the PDF for each phrase and write the highlight. Phrases that wrap across two or three lines are written as one highlight instead of several fragments.